



B.P. Srivastava with family

via one of the most rigid situations BEL has ever been in. “There was a misunderstanding between the governments of the United States and India, and the former imposed sanctions on BEL. It was a tough situation to be in,” he recalls.

“BEL was put on the banned list for exports. We started working with the Department of Commerce and a lot of other stakeholders in the USA to bring BEL out of the ban,” explains Srivastava. He was having a constant dialogue with the industries and all stakeholders BEL was procuring from the US.

He adds, “That gave me a perspective of how things work on the global stage. I got to understand fire-fighting, how international business is done, and a lot of other things”.

According to Srivastava, the circumstances that he and his family went through when he was young made everything else look “solvable.” The single sweater that he had while growing up gave him a

different outlook towards the world and the problems it faces. In his words, “he unknowingly developed an approach where he, instead of asking questions, wanted to ask the right questions!”

In his professional innings with BEL so far, the organisation has asked him to change base six times and, according to Srivastava, every posting has been a demanding yet rewarding one. The toughest assignment at BEL, he recalls, has been the one where he was posted as the general manager of Naval Systems. “Sonar, communications, and a lot of other things made things complex for me. Additionally, it was tough because we had to work with a lot of customers,” he says.

Radio equipment, data equipment, switches, radar systems, sonar systems, communication systems, missile systems, surface-to-air missile (SAM) systems, are some of the technologies and solutions that Srivastava has worked on at BEL so far.

After his three-year stint in New York, he was once again asked to work at Kotdwara! This time he was posted to this unit for 10 years! As he recalls, “After New York, which is seen as a corporate posting, I was asked where I would like to be posted. I told my seniors anywhere they liked, and I was once again given Kotdwara.”

Leading BEL

During April 2022, Srivastava was promoted to the Board as Director (Other Units). Other Units of BEL include the eight manufacturing units of BEL across India (other than the oldest unit at Bengaluru) – Ghaziabad, Kotdwara, Panchkula, Pune, Navi Mumbai, Hyderabad, Machilipatnam, and Chennai. As Operational Head of Other Units, he has the overall responsibility and accountability for the growth and profitability of these eight units. He gave a major thrust to improving the turnaround time of products to meet the delivery timelines and ensure the fast-track execution of capital projects.

Since November 2022, Srivastava is also holding Additional Charge as Chairman & Managing Director of BEL and is responsible for the efficient functioning of BEL to achieve its corporate objectives and performance parameters as per the MoU signed between BEL and the Ministry of Defence, Government of India. Srivastava says, “Having a modest background during my early days, I never aspired to lead BEL. Apart from my passion for my work, my professional journey has been supported by God’s grace.”

“If we look at the business environment of BEL, the defence business segment continues to remain dynamic. It is constantly changing due to ecosystem drivers like procurement policies, industry competition, rapid advances in technology, R&D policies, and the global geopolitical